



WHEN INDIA GOT its freedom in 1947, it was an amalgamation of more than 550 princely states and thousands of *zamindari* estates covering 40 per cent of the land area and 23 per cent of the popula-

ecosystem has resulted in the average life expectancy of males to increase from 37 years in 1951 to 68 years today. For females the improvement has been even better—from 36 years to 70 years. Infant mortality rate has dropped from 140 at the time of independence to 30 in 2019. It gives a sense of pride of what we have accomplished as a nation in the past 75 years. In technology-intensive areas like space and nuclear programmes we have made significant headway and are counted amongst the leading nations. The economy has transformed itself from a closed agrarian economy to an

private sector has resulted in India becoming a hub for IT services, we are still not perceived as technologically oriented and innovative across a larger spectrum of industries.

India today is at an inflexion point from where we can accelerate our development and leadership journey significantly. Geopolitical events have resulted in India becoming a country of choice for multinationals looking at de-risking their supply chain. In this decade we will surpass China as the most populous nation. India has a demographic dividend window of the next 10-15



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Envisioning the India of 2047

The India of today is at an inflexion point and hereon, it can only accelerate its journey to the top

tion. Today, India, after 75 years of freedom, has come a long way.

Over the past seven decades, India has seen several ups and downs. Today with a \$3.17-trillion economy, India is the fifth-largest economy in the world. This has been a remarkable journey. Just about one Indian out of five was literate in 1950. Today, the literacy rate is close to 80 per cent. There are over 1,000 universities imparting quality education. Improvement in the healthcare

open economy led by services.

However, the development has not always been uniform. There is still a wide gap in the economic prosperity of the states with the per capita income ranging from ₹50,000 to ₹4 lakh. The literacy rate also varies from 62 per cent to 94 per cent. Access to basic amenities like water, electricity, education and healthcare continues to be a challenge for many districts in parts of the country. While continued focus by the government and investment by the

years with 1 million people being added to the workforce every month. India also has an advantage of lower wage rates. The government's focus on strengthening the manufacturing sector through the PLI schemes and 'AatmaNirbharBharat' is a step in the right direction. Investment in manufacturing yields the best returns for an economy as every rupee invested generates ₹1.35 in indirect economic activity. Manufacturing also provides employment over a broad spectrum of skill levels.